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BARNEY FRANK 1940-2026

A quintessential legislator, and a trailblazer

Barney Frank, shown at a parade in Fall River in 1989, was in office for 40 years between Beacon Hill and Capitol Hill.



By David Shribman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Barney Frank — a decades-long fixture in Massachusetts Democratic politics, a veteran US House member, a pioneering gay-rights advocate, and a leading figure in the battle to recover from the 2008 Great Recession — died Tuesday evening in his Ogunquit, Maine, home of complications from congestive heart failure. He was 86.

His death was confirmed by Jim Segel, a longtime friend of Mr. Frank's.

Unlike major Bay State political figures such as Henry Cabot Lodge, John F. Kennedy, and Thomas P. "Tip" O'Neill Jr., Mr. Frank was influential in the three dimensions of local, state, and national politics. He left his fingerprints on how Boston is governed, how the Legislature operates on Beacon Hill, and how the House works on Capitol Hill.

His reach also extended into the American economy and the American culture, into how Wall Street operates and how

►Political leaders remember him fondly. **B1.**

FRANK, Page C9

Suit calls for better integration of schools

9 students of color target unequal system in Mass.

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

A group of students of color are challenging a basic framework of public education in Massachusetts, arguing that organizing schools by individual communities has resulted in widespread racial segregation in which Black and Latino students languish in low-performing schools with high levels of poverty.

Backed by several community and legal organizations, the students on Wednesday filed a lawsuit in Suffolk Superior Court challenging that unequal system in hopes of forcing state educational leaders to foster greater racial integration in public schools.

The plaintiffs are seeking voluntary measures to increase integration, such as expanding opportunities to attend schools in other districts. They are not seeking a court-ordered mandate to redraw school district boundaries, which has sparked controversy in previous school desegregation cases around the nation.

The nine Black and Latino student-plaintiffs contend Massachusetts education leaders are denying them their right to an adequate and equal education under the state's constitution by maintaining a system of racially segregated public schools, and have not done nearly enough to encourage integration or improve schools that largely serve Black and Latino student populations.

The students attend schools in Springfield, Holyoke, Boston, Lawrence, Brockton, Lynn, and Worcester, which are among the most racially segregated districts in the state and have among the lowest test scores and graduation rates.

DESEGREGATION, Page A10

Keeping the coneheads coming



SnacksBox co-owner Ligia Van dipped soft-serve vanilla ice cream in melted butter. Yes, it's officially over the top.

Ice cream is getting wilder around here, and it's not just the tastes

By Devra First
GLOBE STAFF

I'm standing on Newbury Street in the blazing sun, waiting in line with everyone else. The object of our desire is just ahead, being handed through the window of a food truck called SnacksBox, parked on the side of the road. I am here, we are here, because the algorithm showed us something we couldn't resist.

This time, that something is soft serve. Soft serve dipped in melted butter. The butter hardens into a shell as it coats the frozen dessert, which is served with a lobster-shaped cone, a New England spin on a fish-shaped Japanese taiyaki cake. Then it's festooned with festive cock-



The butter hardens into a shell and it's served in a lobster-shaped cone.

tail umbrellas and toothpicks tipped with little red lobsters. It's gloriously, gleefully over the top.

According to market research, chocolate is still America's favorite ice cream flavor, followed by butter pecan (really?) and then vanilla. So says the International Dairy Foods Association, in its 2026 Ice Cream & Frozen Novelty Trends Survey. But you wouldn't know it in Boston, where this season's ice cream flavors have become increasingly unhinged.

(Unless you're Steven Tyler. When the Aerosmith frontman got a cone in Quincy last weekend, he kept it simple, with vanilla-coffee soft serve from Bella's Creamery. Some people have enough flair on their own.)

ICE CREAM, Page A10

Another World Cup match: state vs. city

Officials battle over closing part of Summer St. for safety

By Danny McDonald, Chris Serres, and Michael Silverman
GLOBE STAFF

The World Cup may bill itself as a unifying event, but this being Boston, it has inevitably triggered tense political clashing between government officials over crowd control plans for a block near South Station barely bigger than a couple of soccer pitches.

State transportation officials want to shut the section of Summer Street between South Station and Fort Point Channel to vehicle traffic for all seven local World Cup matches as a safety measure for fans taking the train to the games, according to a letter the agency sent to City Hall.

With Boston officials balking at the request, T officials suggested the state will simply take over that stretch of street with or without the city's buy-in.

With less than a month to the kickoff of the games in Foxborough, the finger-pointing has added further tension to what have become underwhelming preparations and event-planning for the international tournament.

"I really don't know how we got here. This is a major international event, this should've been

WORLD CUP, Page A7

Fanning out

Thursday: Back to spring. High 62-67. Low 48-53.

Friday: Some sun, still cool. High 62-67. Low 51-56.

High tide: 3:11 a.m., 3:59 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:17 Sunset: 8:05

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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Federal prosecutors announced criminal charges against former Cuban president Raúl Castro in the 1996 downing of civilian planes flown by Miami-based exiles. **A2.**

Almost two years after a State Police recruit died, the agency is overhauling its training program, leaving behind a focus on excessive punishment. **B1.**

Faculty at Harvard University voted to limit the number of A's they can award, a significant shift in policy meant to rein in grade inflation. **B1.**

The Red Sox finished sweeping the Royals with a 4-3 win. **C1.**

When minutes count, would you step up?

YVONNE ABRAHAM
COMMENTARY

You want to think you'd do more.

You watch as much as you can stand of the video of Steven McCluskey falling then getting trapped at the bottom of the escalator at the Davis Square Station on a frigid Friday morning, his clothes getting pulled into the machinery and choking him. A couple of minutes later, other commuters start arriving. Some see him, some don't. Some stop, and some don't. A couple try to help, but appear to give up. Nobody pushes the button that stops the stairs moving.

You hope you would have made better decisions. It's easy to see now what so many people didn't see before sunrise on Feb. 27. You'd like to think you

would have done the thing that could have saved him.

Would you?

It starts in the most mundane way. McCluskey steps onto the escalator, black jacket, gray hoodie up, at 4:58 a.m., according to the timestamp on the video. He holds the railing and a gray lunch bag in his left hand, then lets go briefly near the bottom. Forty seconds after he steps onto the escalator, he loses his footing on the last step and falls backward. He tries to get up but his clothing is caught in the moving stairs.

Still seated at first, he struggles to free himself.

Would you do better than the man in the gray hat?

He arrives at the top of the escalator at 4:59 a.m., 30 seconds after McCluskey's fall. At that moment, McCluskey is being pulled back into a lying position, his clothes drawn deeper into the stairs. Does the man recognize what he is seeing? He watches from above for 21 seconds before taking the stairs. At the bottom, the man seems like he's going to keep walking, but he turns back and takes the trapped man's right arm, briefly. He seems to say something to McCluskey — does McCluskey say

ABRAHAM, Page A7